coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 6
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artwork Spotlight: Katy Grannan's Portraits
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Katy Grannan on Taking Portraits
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Between Subject and Object

- ✓ Exploring Agency
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Susan Meiselas on Carnival Strippers, 1973–75
  Video • 5 min
- ✓ Self-Possession
  Reading • 4 min

Part III: Individuals and Types

- ✓ Performing Identity
  Reading • 7 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Akram Zaatari on After They Got the Right to Arms. Fourteen young men posing with guns, early 1970s/2006
  Video • 6 min
- ✓ Hear More: Stephanie Syjuco on Cargo Cults, 2013–16
  Video • 2 min

Part IV: Strangers and Friends

- ✓ Loved Ones
  Reading • 7 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Tina Barney on Sunday New York Times, 1982
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Hear More: Deana Lawson on Roxie and Raquel, 2010
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Hear More: Maria Antelman on Puzzlers, 2020
  Video • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Part I: Introduction

- ○ **Introduction to Module 7**
  Reading • 3 min
- ○ Sarah Meister on the Ocean of Images
  Video • 2 min

Part II: Analogue Ancestors

- ○ Before the Digital Wave
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Gertrudes Altschul. Lines and Tones. c. 1952
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Appropriating Mass Media
  Reading • 8 min
- ○ Hear More: Eva Respini on Robert Heinecken. Are You Rea. 1964–68
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Martha Rosler on House Beautiful: Bringing the War Home, 1967–72
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Hear More: Carmen Winant on My Birth, 2018
  Video • 2 min

Part III: Digital Oceans

- ○ Born Digital
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Hear More: Thomas Ruff on jpeg msh01, 2004
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Anouk Kruithof on Subconscious Travelling, 2013
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Hear More: Lucas Blalock on Strawberries, 2014–15
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Hear More: David Horvitz on Mood Disorder, 2015
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Hear More: Özlem Altın on Topography (of time, of body), 2019
  Video • 5 min

Part IV: Review and Respond

- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Creative Challenge
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Final Assignment
  Graded Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ End of Course Survey
  Reading • 5 min

Introduction to Module 7

1:43 / 2:04 1x

Ocean of Images

Before 1888, making photographs was difficult, requiring specialized training and cumbersome equipment. In that year, the Eastman Kodak Company introduced an inexpensive, easy-to-use, handheld camera, which promised: "You Press the Button, We Do the Rest." With photography accessible to a much broader audience, anyone could take a picture. Since then, evolving photographic technologies have made taking and distributing pictures increasingly simple, with the result that photography has become ever more fully integrated into daily life. Now, with the proliferation of digital cameras, smart phones, and social media platforms, trillions of images are shared online each year, adding to those we encounter on television, in print publications, and in advertisements. It can seem that we are submerged in an ocean of images.

Since the 1960s, artists have been exploring both the means and the effects of our constant exposure to images and the power they have in shaping our understanding of ourselves and the world around us. Artists demonstrate that images are malleable—that their meaning is not necessarily fixed but, rather, can be determined by a great number of external factors. They are examining the methods and technologies used in making and circulating images, and the ways in which these systems affect how the images are viewed and interpreted. They consider the use and manipulation of images in advertising and the mass media, and, perhaps most importantly, analyze how our engagement with images today affects our relationships with truth and reality.

Learning Objectives

- Examine the role of evolving photographic technologies in our past and present visual culture.
- Discover some of the ways artists examine—and frequently disrupt—current methods of image production, presentation, and circulation.
- Analyze how the use and manipulation of images in advertising and the mass media affects our relationships with truth and reality.

Mark as completed

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